

Last modified on

Sports Data Soccer API - Commentary Feed (MA6)

Get an automated and/or a manual set of commentary messages to update the reader on the key match events.

Overview

The Soccer **Commentary feed** produces an automated and, in some cases, a manual ('live') set of commentary messages to update the reader on the key match events. It is available in a number of languages. The feed response consists of a breakdown of the key events with a line of text for a number of different types of events, including these and many more: goals, attempts, cards, substitutions, fouls, offsides, corners, free kicks, delays in play, start/end of a half.

Importantly, you can specify a preferred commentary type - auto or manual (live) - or the 'fallback' option in your calls. If you request the fallback type, the API will first search for the manual (live) commentary and return it if available - but if it is not, it will search for the automated version and return it if found. Here, we explain how to construct your calls, the expected API behavior, and the data that you can expect to receive.

Behind Closed Doors and Limited Audience matches: We have implemented a way to highlight when a match will be played behind closed doors or with a limited audience. When these conditions apply, new attributes for `attendanceInfoId` and `attendanceInfo` will be delivered in the feed under the `matchInfo` element. For more information, see: [Feed Output](#)

- **Auto Commentary:** In the `message` element, the `"type"` attribute has a new possible value of `"penalty goal"`. This is to help users differentiate between different types of goals. Note: This makes it consistent with the Manual commentary version, which already has this.
- **Manual Commentary:** In the `message` element, the `"type"` attribute has a new possible value of `"second_yellow red card"`. This is used when a player is shown a second yellow card. Note: This makes it consistent with the Auto commentary version, which already has this.

Messages and attributes added to include information about any VAR reviews on goal events. These changes will be reflected in all languages that the feed is produced in. In the following scenarios, the below attributes and values will be present in the `message` element following the VAR review.

1. Goals scored and confirmed after VAR review:

`comment="{text string}. Goal confirmed following VAR review." + varCheck="yes"`

2. Goal awarded after VAR review: `comment="{text string}. Goal awarded following VAR review." + varCheck="yes"`

3. Goal cancelled after VAR review: `comment="GOAL CANCELLED BY VAR: {text string}." + type="Deleted after review" + varCheck="yes"`

Required Compliance:

To comply with our API security and best practice logic for your API calls please refer to our [FAQs](#). We also recommend that you take a look at our [API Overview and Authentication Guide](#). You will learn the basics of how our API works and key concepts to get started.

How Often Should I Poll The Feed?

We have provided some guidelines to help ensure that you call the feed only as often as you need to. Make sure that you don't exceed the rate confirmed with us - this can vary depending on whether you make requests as a B2B or B2C outlet - if you need more information on this, contact your Stats Perform representative.

Note: **<KO -/+ xh; KO -/+ xh>** = a time range (<>) -/+ KO time, **KO** = Kick-Off time, **d** = day (eg 1d), **h** = hour (eg 1h), **m** = minute (eg 1m), **s** = seconds (eg 30s)

UPDATED	POLLING FREQUENCY							
	TIER 15	TIER 12+14	TIER 4	TIER 11+13	TIER 8+9+10	TIER 6+7	TIER 5	TIER 1+2+3
Updated on a line-up announcement, start/end half, goal, shot at goal, card, foul, offside, corner won, delays in play, or match postponed/abandoned	See Tier 13	Post-match	n/a	No more than one poll: • <KO-1h; KO+4h> every 30s • <KO+4h; KO+8h> on intervals up to 1h • 8h+ of match end time: on intervals of up to 24h (for a maximum of 7d)	No more than one poll: • <KO-1h; KO+4h> every 30s • <KO+4h; KO+8h> on intervals up to 1h • 8h+ of match end time: on intervals of up to 24h (for a maximum of 7d)	n/a	n/a	n/a

Commentary (MA6) Guide

USAGE	FEED
GET a commentary by fixture UUID (path parameter)	/soccerdata/commentary/{outletAuthKey}/{fixt
GET a commentary by fixture UUID (fx parameter - supports legacy IDs)	/soccerdata/commentary/{outletAuthKey}?fx={f

If your request URL is as follows (does not contain the fixture UUID query criteria), the feed returns an error:

Query Parameters And Example Request Parameters

This feed also makes use of the **Global query parameters**, such as the `_lcl` (locale) parameter, and you can combine them with the following query parameters (some of which can be used in conjunction with each other). However, you must query the `/commentary` feed by a specific fixture (match) UUID.

Legacy IDs: You can use the `fx` parameter to filter by legacy IDs - only one ID is supported (you cannot pass multiple IDs in a comma-separated list).

How to use query parameters and make successful requests:

In our guides, we use HTTPS syntax for our example `GET` requests (rather than `cURL`, for example). All URLs are case-sensitive - this means that URL strings must contain the correct case and operators. You **MUST** format your requests correctly and include certain information; otherwise, an error will be returned. You can find information about the API, including the base URL (`{protocol}://{requestDomain}/{feedResource}`), in the **main guide** and **API Overview and Authorisation guide**.

- Include the following information in the URL or header and make sure it is correct for your outlet: your unique and valid `{outletAuthKey}` this must be after the Outlet Authentication Key (and endpoint, if applicable). for `_rt={mode}` (operating mode) and `_fmt={dataFormat}` (response format), entity query parameter and UUID.
- Begin the query parameter string with `?` (question mark) - this must be after the Outlet Authentication Key (and endpoint, if applicable). To build up a query string, make sure that each query parameter is separated by the `&` (ampersand) operator. Values must be separated by the correct operator, for example `&` (multiple values, 'AND'), or `-` (multiple values, 'OR') or `!` ('NOT').
- Use the required `_` (underscore) for any parameters listed with this prefix.
- Remove any placeholder value curly braces `{ }` from your calls (we include these as an example only).
- If using the JSONP format (`_fmt=jsonp`) you **MUST** use it in combination with the callback parameter (`_cblk`) and a fixed value (or where you use a different value in a different instance, you must do this as little as possible). Be aware that common JavaScript frameworks, such as jQuery, can default to use randomly-generated function names - you must make sure that these are overridden and define a fixed function name instead.

Query parameter	Value and description
<code>{fixtureUuid}</code> Fixture UUID	Get commentary data for a match by the specified fixture UUID (path parameter method). Pass the fixture UUID in the request URL directly as the <code>{assetId}</code> (asset/resource ID). Note: Only one ID is supported (you cannot pass multiple IDs in a comma-separated list). <pre>GET https://api.performfeeds.com/soccerdata/commentary/{outletAuthKey}/{fixtureUuid}?_rt={mode}&_fmt={dataFormat}</pre>

Query parameter	Value and description
fx	Get a commentary by legacy fixture ID. Note: As this function may be removed in the future, we recommend using the path parameter method if you are not using legacy IDs. <pre>GET https://api.performfeeds.com/soccerdata/commentary/{outletAuthKey}?_rt={mode}&_fmt={dataFormat}&fx={fixtureUuid}</pre>
type	Get an extended list of (detailed) statistics. Pass one of the following values to the type parameter - see Commentary types and feed behaviour for more information on the feed behaviour associated with each value. manual - live manual commentary auto - automated commentary (default if the 'type' parameter is not specified) fallback - live manual commentary with a fallback to automated commentary if a manual commentary does not exist <pre>GET https://api.performfeeds.com/soccerdata/commentary/{outletAuthKey}/{fixtureUuid}?_rt={mode}&_fmt={dataFormat}&type={type}</pre>
lcl	1. Get a commentary for multiple languages using _lcl parameter using comma separated values for language codes. E.g., _lcl=cn,ar,en, if you want to query the feed together for Chinese, Arabic and English. <pre>GET https://api.performfeeds.com/soccerdata/commentary/{outletAuthKey}?_rt={mode}&_fmt={dataFormat}&fx={fixtureUuid}&type={type}&_lcl=cn,ar,en</pre> 2. The feed can now be queried using a wildcard character (*) in place of language codes. E.g., _lcl=* if you want to query the feed for all available languages. <pre>GET https://api.performfeeds.com/soccerdata/commentary/{outletAuthKey}?_rt={mode}&_fmt={dataFormat}&fx={fixtureUuid}&type={type}&_lcl=*</pre> Note: - A multi-language query will show results based on what you have authorized to access - If you query multiple languages where none of the languages are subscribed, the feed will return a 10400 error code - The feed can be queried with any type (double/single) of language codes - If you are querying multiple languages together, matchInfo node will be translated to the default language

Commentary Types And Feed Logic

In your call, you should include the **type** parameter and a value (specify the type of commentary) and the **_lcl** parameter and a value (specify the locale-language) to query the feed by.

type=fallback | manual live or auto text commentary

Example: **?_lcl=en-us&type=fallback**

1. This request starts a search for a manual live text commentary (**type>manual**) in US English language (**en-us**)
2. If a manual live text commentary IS found, it is returned in **en-us** (US English) language

3. If a manual live text commentary IS NOT found (in US English), then it will search for an automated text commentary (`type=auto`) in US English language (`en-us`)
4. If an automated text commentary IS NOT found in US English, then HTTP 404 is returned

`type=manual` | manual live text commentary

Example: `?_lcl=en-us&type=manual`

1. This request starts a search for a manual live text commentary (`type=manual`) in US English language (`en-us`)
2. If a manual live text commentary IS found, it is returned in `en-us` (US English) language
3. If a manual live text commentary IS NOT found (in US English), then HTTP 404 is returned

`type=auto` | automated text commentary

Example: `?_lcl=en-us&type=auto`

1. This request starts a search for an automated text commentary (`type=auto`) in US English language (`en-us`)
2. If an automated text commentary IS found, it is returned in `en-us` (US English) language
3. If an automated text commentary IS NOT found, the API will search for an automated commentary in `en-gb` (British/UK English) language and returned if found
4. If an automated text commentary in `en-gb` (British/UK English) language IS NOT found, then HTTP 404 is returned

Note - default locale: `en-gb` (British/UK English) language is the default language in the SDAPI and is used for all `_lcl` parameter values when searching for an automated text commentary - not only for English-based locale languages. For example, if you were to specify `type=auto&_lcl=xx-yy` and an automated text commentary did not exist in the matching language (`xx-yy`), the feed would return the commentary in UK English if it existed).

Supported Languages

The Commentary feed can potentially support the following languages, but support can differ between the 'Auto' and 'Manual' versions of the feed/commentary. You must specify the language/locale value to the `_lcl` parameter to return the feed in a particular language. If you do not specify the parameter, the feed language defaults to English. For example, `_lcl=en-gb`

Note:

- The feed returns results in the English language by the default if you do not specify the locale parameter)
- The feed may accept more values than those given here - see the **Global parameters** (`_lcl`) Guide for a full list of locale codes and the previously-supported values. For example: `es-es` instead of `es` , `es-419` instead of `e1` `es1` `e1-e1`
- Multi language query will show results based on what a client is authorized to access
- The feed can be queried with any type (double/single) of language codes
- If a client queries multiple languages where none of the language is subscribed by the client, the feed will return 10400 error code.
- In case a client is querying multiple languages together, `matchInfo` node will be translated to default language
- Check with your Account Manager for information about the supported languages for each sport and competition. The table below is designed to show the languages that could be supported through the Sports Data API (SDAPI), but it is not a definitive list of all currently supported languages

Supported Languages - Auto Vs Manual

LANGUAGE	PARAMETER VALUE	MA6 AUTO	MA6 MANUAL
English (United Kingdom)	en-gb	Y	Y
English (United States)	en-us	N	Y
English (Australia)	en-au	Y	Y
French (France)	fr-fr	Y	N
German (Deutsch, Germany)	de-de	Y	Y
Italian (Italy)	it-it	Y	Y
Spanish (Spain)	es-es	Y	Y
Portuguese (Portugal)	pt-pt	Y	N
Dutch (Netherlands)	nl-nl	Y	N
Norwegian Bokmål (Norway)	nb-no	Y	N
Norwegian Nynorsk (Norway)	nn-no	Y	N
Swedish (Sweden)	sv-se	Y	N
Danish (Denmark)	da-dk	Y	N
Catalan (Spain)	ca-es	Y	N
Spanish (Latin American)	es-419	Y	Y
Brazilian Portuguese	pt-br	Y	Y
Indonesian (Bahasa Indonesia)	id-id	Y	Y
Turkish	tr	N	Y
Chinese - Simplified	zh-cn	N	Y
Arabic	ar-sa	N	Y

Sample Calls

These sample calls let you see an example URL and the response - click on the links below (hyperlinks open in a new window).

- **XML** - 'auto' type commentary, no locale specified (uses default - normally English)
- **XML** - 'auto' type commentary, German (Germany) locale specified (`_lcl=de-de`)
- **JSON** - 'manual' type commentary, no locale specified (uses default)
- **JSON** - 'fallback' type commentary, no locale specified (uses default)
- **XML** - contains VAR-related messages, 'auto' type commentary
- **XML** - contains VAR-related messages, 'manual' type commentary

Feed Output

Here, you can find an explanation of all possible response fields and data. This is XML but fields in the feed response are similar for JSON.

▶<commentary> (XML only)

▶<matchInfo>

▶<description>

▶<sport>

▶<ruleset>

▶<competition>

▶<country>

▶<tournamentCalendar>

▶<stage>

▶<series>

▶<contestants>

▶<contestant>

▶<country>

▶<venue>

▶<messages>

▶<message>